The M-ZRT (Morin Z-Reduction Task): A Practical Example

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Purpose: A monitoring system in the brain is thought to restrict access to joy. When it detects deliberate attempts to produce or evaluate a state, it intervenes and the experience collapses. In that sense, the procedure functions like a hide-and-seek game with the monitor: if it notices the goal, the state disappears. The protocol decreases the rigidity of the monitor, as long as it is discreet enough so it doesn't detect the attempt.

It only works if it is not approached as an exercise to improve. A few tries over a few days are enough, and repeating it a lot tends to remove the effect.

With a video-game

Download unreal tournament, quake or similar.

Open the game, remove HUD in the option.

No excessive muscle tension, including jaw and shoulders.

Play, without trying to win or to be competitive.

Move your shoulders with no rhythm for a few seconds while playing.

Drink a sip of coffee.

Continue to play a bit if you want, then close the game, and don't evaluate the result, simply forget about it and continue your day.

Do that only every 24h or so, for 2-3 minutes. Not everyday: skip a day randomly.

Nothing is supposed to happen. If you try to make it into a method or to improve the result, the task is already over.

You fail the task if:

You analyze it
You do it more than 3 minutes per day and more than one time per day
You try to improve the task
You follow the task "to get an effect"
You evaluate if you do the task right
You take too much coffee (more than a sip)
You take coffee everytime -> coffee must not be every day
You take coffee with the same timing -> don't think about the timing too much, or vary it
You do micro-mouvement multiple-times -> only once per session, you do one time, you continue to play without thinking about it anymore
You do micro-mouvements for too long (more than a few secondes)

With a cartoon

No excessive muscle tension, including jaw and shoulders.

Launch this cartoon video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Hps_NyqEyKk (any absurd cartoon is accepted).

Play the video while occasionally clicking random spots on the timeline without trying to find anything.

Move your shoulders with no rhythm for a few seconds while watching.

Drink a sip of coffee.

Continue to watch a bit if you want, then close the video, and don't evaluate the result, simply forget about it and continue your day.

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One-time exercice

These are one-time exercises. They are meant to be performed only once in a lifetime and not repeated. Repetition would quickly transform them into a routine, which would reintroduce anticipation, monitoring, and evaluation. The value of these exercises lies precisely in their uniqueness: they occur once, without preparation, without optimization, and without expectation of reproducing the effect. After completing the exercise, it should simply be left behind and not revisited or analyzed later. Each exercise lasts only a few seconds. Comparison tends to re-activate the monitoring process, so avoid trying to choose between them for long. Not more than 2 exercises a day.

The exercices:

Look at the time, then proceed as if you had not seen it, without modifying your behavior.

Start a music video. As soon as you notice it becoming enjoyable, close it.

On youtube, deliberately choose a sub-optimal video. Do not optimize the selection.

Ask a question in your head and leave it unanswered.

Form a simple mental image (e.g., a red apple). Do not refresh it. Do not force it to stay. Simply notice when it fades. Do not try to extend it.

Open a book at random. Read one paragraph. Then jump to another random page and read another paragraph.

Look at an object, a thought, or a sound. Internally label it as ‘almost interesting’. Not interesting. Not neutral. Almost.

Look at an object, label it as the most important in the room. Don’t look at it directly.

In a noisy environment, pick one sound as primary (a voice, a bird, a distant car), treat it as central.

Perform a deliberately precise gesture with no utility (e.g., place an object perfectly parallel to an imaginary line). After it is done, make zero corrections, even if it is not perfect.

While walking, stop abruptly for no reason. Walk again without analyzing why you stopped.

Generate a feeling of recognition or approval, as if you were acknowledging someone, but with no recipient.

Generate the internal sense of ‘something important is about to happen’.

Notes

Participants are encouraged to minimize high-load obligations and socially evaluative contexts on test days.

Intrusive imagined social scenarios, such as arguments or anticipated confrontations, should also be reduced where possible. More broadly, avoiding news consumption, scrolling, comment reading, and exposure to social-media metrics may help limit re-engagement of evaluative monitoring.

Similarly, reducing repeated time-checking and unnecessary muscular tension, including jaw tension, may contribute to the same effect.

Repeated exposure to the protocol may decrease, rather than increase, the probability of entry. For this reason, sessions are spaced by approximately 24 hours, not as a training schedule, but to reduce procedural carryover and allow evaluative monitoring to settle between attempts.

Random omission of scheduled sessions is recommended to reduce temporal predictability and prevent schedule-based expectancy formation, which may otherwise reactivate anticipatory monitoring.

The first successful transition may occur only after several null sessions. Within a threshold framework, such delay is not interpreted as gradual training progress, but as evidence of an entry barrier. Repeated failure followed by a sudden discontinuity is therefore treated as expected behavior rather than as an anomaly.

Reference:
“The Morin Z-Reduction Task (M-ZRT): Suspension of Instrumental Framing as a Threshold Mechanism for Ease”:
https://florianmorin.com/papers/Morin-Z-Reduction-Task.html